

How to Contribute to GNOME

The open source community thrives on the involvement and support of users to make open source a truly people's movement. 'Involvement' has many aspects to it, and includes monetary contributions, writing, designing, coding, translating or testing.



G NOME is one of the leading open source organisations in the world. A lot of people work for it, fixing bugs, implementing new features, etc. Since people use various platforms for this, here's a simple guide to installing the source code for GNOME on different platforms. Also learn how you can begin with your first contribution towards open source using GNOME and a few of its developer tools. You can contribute to different parts such as the GNOME shell, GNOME-music, GNOME-games, Evolution, Evolution data server, etc.

Hardware requirements

While installing the GNOME source code, you first need to install its dependencies. The minimum hardware requirements for the build are:

- 2GB RAM and a lot of free space
- To debug and to build: At least 8GB of free space

- For optimised builds: At least 1GB of free space (6GB recommended)

Build tools and dependencies

In GNOME, it is not necessary to have the dependencies. You only need to install JHBuild, which is a tool developed and used to build the whole GNOME desktop from the Git source. It can also be used to build other projects, creating a moduleset for it. Unlike some build scripts, JHBuild lets you specify what modules you want to build and, accordingly, it will build those modules, including the dependencies. JHBuild is preferred by developers who install GNOME from source.

Installing JHBuild

JHBuild helps users by making the installation process much easier. It needs the Python runtime environment, with version 2.3 as the least recommended.

The recommended way of downloading JHBuild is via the Git version control system. This can be done with the following command. It is recommended that you run the command from a new directory where all the source code will be installed, for example, ~/jhbuild/checkout.

```
git clone git://git.gnome.org/jhbuild
```

This will download JHBuild into a new folder named *JHBuild* under the current working directory. To build and install JHBuild, use the following commands:

```
cd jhbuild
...
./autogen.sh
...
make
...
make install
```

If *gnome-common*, *Yelp-tools* and *Autotools* are available, *autogen.sh* will configure JHBuild to install via Autotools.

If the three are not available, *autogen.sh* will configure JHBuild to install them via a plain

Makefile. To always use the plain Makefile method, pass *--simple-install* to *autogen.sh*

